

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Robert Kearey

Address: 8 The Drive Wallington SM6 9LX

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to object to the proposed Mosque scheme under the headings described below:

Increased Traffic & Road Safety Risks

The proposed site is located in an area already experiencing substantial traffic congestion and parking issues, particularly during the Avenue Primary School drop-off and pick-up periods when vehicle queues, limited manoeuvring space and restricted visibility are common. I have observed these conditions when collecting my grandchildren from the School. Access for emergency vehicles to Dorset Road, York Road, Holland Avenue and Avenue Road is already difficult. Additional vehicle movements to and from the proposed Mosque scheme will only exacerbate existing congestion and increase road safety and community risks.

School Safety

Avenue Primary School is in close proximity to the proposed development and has a pupil capacity of up to 1,050 students. At morning drop-off and afternoon collection times, there are exceptionally high numbers of pedestrian and vehicle movements. Large numbers of children, parents, pushchairs, and cyclists use the surrounding pavements and crossings, creating a very crowded environment. Any further vehicle and pedestrian movements would materially increase risks to child safety.

Impact on Local Recreational Facilities and Facilities for the Elderly

In addition to the school, the area is served by recreational facilities including tennis courts and an elderly residents' facility. These facilities generate steady vehicle circulation and parking demand throughout the day and into the evening. The presence of elderly persons, some with reduced mobility, adds to safety concerns and must be considered when assessing the impact of the proposed Mosque scheme.

Noise and Night-Time Disturbance

The proposed introduction of a community hall, temple, mosque or similar facility would result in concentrated user arrival and departure patterns throughout the day, particularly during evenings, weekends, and special events. Such additional congestion would inevitably create noise nuisance and disturbance to local residents and detract from what is presently a quiet residential neighbourhood.

Exterior Design Proposal

The proposed Mosque scheme elevations, with increased building height compared with the existing building would create a structure that is visually dominant and in sharp contrast to the domestic scale of neighbouring properties. There do not appear to be any details of the first floor of the proposed scheme to enable public comment at this planning application stage.

Summary

In summary, the Mosque scheme proposal would, if adopted:

- Materially increase highway safety risk to pedestrians and other road users
- Diminish existing residential amenity
- Detract visually from the character of the local neighbourhood